Name: PRANJAL SWARUP BHATNAGAR **Reg. No.:** RA2512703010007
Course: 21LEM202T - Universal Human Values - II

Unit – 4 : Session – 9 | Holistic Approach (Samadhan), Managing Water, Preserving Nature

Part C — Long-Answer Questions (Solutions)

1. Q1. THE FOUR-STEP HOLISTIC APPROACH (SAMADHAN): (1) CLARITY of the all-encompassing solution — recognising that the root of problems is in the human being's assumption and conduct, so the solution must encompass understanding, conduct, constitution and order; (2) EFFORT for it through HUMAN EDUCATION (right understanding in every self), HUMAN CONDUCT (definite harmonious living), HUMAN CONSTITUTION (frameworks securing right conduct) and HUMAN ORDER (systems ensuring the human goal); (3) ANALYSING each problem in the light of samadhan — seeing INHUMAN CONDUCT as the real cause and exploitation/domination as mere symptoms; (4) GETTING RID of the problem by ensuring human conduct through human education. THE DIFFERENCE from the current approach: the current approach treats population or water scarcity as isolated symptoms and applies technology for temporary relief, leaving the cause (unlimited want, inhuman conduct) intact — so the problem returns or shifts. Samadhan removes the cause itself; relief that does not change conduct is only postponement.
2. Q2. THREE EFFORTS and their wide impact: (1) NATURAL FARMING (Subhash Sharma, Maharashtra): farming without chemical inputs, in cyclical harmony with soil life — if practised widely it would reverse soil-fertility loss and food toxicity studied earlier, cut the 21,000-litres-per-kg style water waste, and free farmers from input-debt (addressing human-nature AND human-human problems together). (2) REVERSING DESERTIFICATION (Allan Savory, ~15 million hectares on 5 continents): managed livestock grazing that regenerates grasslands — widely practised, it would restore degraded land (43% of land is human-dominated today), sequester carbon and revive rural livelihoods. (3) URBAN WATER HARVESTING (Vijayanagar/Bengaluru model): every building collecting rainwater — widely adopted, it would recharge the 59%-declining aquifers, end dependence on distant dams/canals, and make cities water-secure. Each effort proves the problems of earlier sessions are solvable by conduct aligned with nature, not by more extraction.
3. Q3. THE SOURABHA PROJECT (Vijayanagar, Bangalore): a 2,400 sq ft plot built in 1995 that has met ALL its water needs from rainwater alone since 1994 — including during construction — with NO municipal/BWSSB connection ever. With ~1000 mm annual rainfall, it collects ~2,23,000 litres per year against a need of ~1,80,000 litres per year, and the surplus RECHARGES GROUND WATER. WHAT IT DEMONSTRATES: (a) RIGHT UTILISATION — the household assessed its real need and lives comfortably within it, collecting more than it consumes; (b) the HUMAN ROLE IN NATURE — not a consumer of a distant utility but a participant who harvests, uses and returns (recharge) — completing nature's cycle rather than breaking it; (c) feasibility — abundance through understanding, on an ordinary urban plot, for three decades. It converts the slogan 'water is abundant but mismanaged' into a lived proof of management.
4. Q4. SELF-REFLECTION / PLEDGE: one effort I can start locally — rooftop rainwater harvesting and a kitchen-garden composting pit at home, documented as a small study-model project. My three-point VALUE-BASED LIVING pledge for harmony with nature: (1) I will consume only after assessing real need — no impulse buying, no food waste (freedom from

obsession for consumption and accumulation); (2) I will participate in nature's cycle daily — segregate and compost waste, save water, walk or cycle for short distances; (3) I will actively enrich — plant and nurture trees every year and support local natural-farming produce — moving from 'what is wrong' to 'what I can do' at the level of self, family and society.